

SURREY SCOUT

JULY/AUGUST, 1980

No. 397

Scout Fellowship

County Sub-Committee

I was most heartened by the attendance at the April meeting of the County Sub-Committee. Thirteen Districts were represented and I trust that at our next meeting on 29th July 1980 this number will be increased.

Group Fellowships

At the above meeting the hoary old question of "Why not Group Fellowships"? was raised and I feel that I should state my feelings on this matter.

I do not approve of Group orientated Scout Fellowships, and will do everything I can to discourage such thinking.

The idea of a District Scout Fellowship is to assemble a body of people, sympathetic to the Movement's ideals, with varying time, talent, skills, which are available to ALL Groups' Sections within the District.

It would be impossible for every Group in every District to have its own Fellowship, with a full range of expertise from administration to Canoeing or Photography to Transportation. I know some large Groups could, but what about our weaker brothers who could not? Are they to be denied access to the help they need?

However much we dislike the idea, parochial attitudes would prevail, and that is why a properly organised and supported District Based Scout Fellowship available to all, is the best thing for all the young people in our Movement.

No doubt not all readers of "Surrey Scout" will agree with me on this matter and I would be pleased to hear from anyone who feels strongly opposed to my views, or who has any problems or views on the Work or Organisation of the Scout Fellowship in their District.

Venture Competition November 15/16 and Perry Wood Camping Competition September 19 to 21

Organisation of these events is well underway and I will be writing to all District Fellowships shortly to confirm acceptance of your offers of help to gently 'prod' those Fellowships yet to make a commitment. **Scout Fellowship Training Course**

The date for this one day course has been altered from the date published in the June "Surrey Scout".

Places on this course are limited, and will be strictly first come, first served. Interest has been shown by Scout Fellowships in other Counties, so please get your application in early.

Odds and Ends

Good black and white or colour photographs of Fellowships in action are still awaited, both work & play. We have the display boards & equipment, but nothing to put on them. Please see what you can find. (Headquarters are making the same appeal so you could find your picture going 'national').

Why not meet up with another Scout Fellowship in the County for a social activity & see how they are organised & what they do. Please keep me advised of such joint events.

Anyone in your Fellowship interested in green bowls? Fred de Graaf of Sunbury & Shepperton would be pleased to hear from you with a view to organising inter District Fellowship matches. (Idea for a Fellowship Social activity?).

Footnote - To all Section Scouters & Group Officials

Do you know what support your District Scout Fellowship can offer you in your work with the young people? Do you know what talents they have in their ranks, what badge courses they could run etc.? If not why not?

Please contact your District Fellowship. They may be able to make your job in Scouting a little easier.

ERIC MACKIE

County Commissioner

Three and a half miles from Gomshall and one mile from Peaslake lies Bentley Copse, the County's training centre and camp site, set in 21 acres of open woodland. This site, originally part of a large estate owned by Lord Ashcombe, then Lord Lieutenant and the first President of the Scout County of Surrey, was first used for camping at the end of the first World War. It passed into the hands of Mr. G.H.S. Parsons, the first District Commissioner for Horley, and later County Secretary. A Resolution of the County Scout Council on 27th October 1927 recorded: "The Surrey Scout Council desire to place on record their very grateful appreciation on the splendid 'good turn' done to the Scouts of Surrey by the late County Secretary and Assistant County Commissioner for Cubs, G.H. Stewart Parsons, in presenting to the Council 13 acres of land known as Bentley Copse near Shere with the Scout hut and offices as a freehold to be held in trust for the Scouts of Surrey."

In 1962 the present Warden's bungalow, "High Banks", was purchased together with the adjoining field bringing the total acreage up to 21. The cost of this purchase was met by a levy of three shillings a head on all members of the County.

In 1965, following the formation of the Greater London Council, part of Surrey was transferred to Greater London South West and parts of Middlesex came into Surrey. In that year Resolutions were passed at General Meetings of the Surrey and G.L.S.W. Scout Councils, agreeing that Bentley Copse should be held in trust jointly for the benefit of the two Counties. A joint Management Committee was formed and both Counties undertook to contribute equally to the upkeep and development of the site.

Over the past 15 years this system worked fairly well and a tremendous amount of work was done to develop the site especially by Percy Neville and Eric Walden, both of whom, sadly, are no longer with us. But one of the difficulties has been the fact that the priorities of the two Counties have changed. While Surrey has always been concerned to develop Bentley Copse as the main County centre, G.L.S.W. have, understandably, had to devote a good deal of effort into developing their mountain base at Bethesda in North Wales.

Following a review of their commitments, G.L.S.W. under the leadership of their new County Commissioner, Phil Menhennett have decided to withdraw from joint ownership of Bentley Copse. No financial

compensation is sought and G.L.S.W. have honoured their commitment to contribute to the first phase of development work on the training buildings. G.L.S.W. will continue to use the training facilities on the normal letting terms and their members will continue to camp at Bentley Copse on the same preferential terms as those enjoyed by Surrey for at least the next five years.

The necessary formal Resolutions to give effect to this decision were passed at the Annual General Meetings of the two Scout Counties last month. Accordingly, Surrey Scout County again has sole responsibility for Bentley Copse which we shall strive to maintain and develop for the benefit of the Scouting community at large, but always with particular warm welcome for our friends from G.L.S.W.

The second phase of development on the training building is already under way. So, shortly, not only shall we have the benefit of the first phase comprising enlarged kitchen facilities fitted out with the proceeds of the Eric Walden Memorial Fund which Mary Walden has generously decided should be devoted to this purpose, but we shall also be able to enjoy the luxury of flush toilets and even showers.

It is to be hoped that these improved facilities will enable much more use to be made of the training facilities at Bentley Copse, not only for adults but also for courses run for the benefit of our younger members as well.

The plans for this development incidentally were prepared as part of a training project at a Commissioners' and G.S.L.s' Advanced Training Course run at Bentley in 1978. It is one of the great strengths of Scouting that a wide variety of professional talent is to be found in our midst which can be channelled into such practical pursuits! Another group on the same course devoted their attention to the development of the camping site, particularly the Bentley Barn — and that is another matter to which we will be giving careful consideration in the years to come.

Whether at Bentley Copse or elsewhere in this country, or on expeditions to distant lands, I hope that everyone going to camp this year will have a really enjoyable time — whatever the weather — and that the opportunity is taken to gain experience of a range of new, worthwhile, activities.

GORDON BATES

Leader Training

Details of courses during the remainder of 1980 are set out below but particular attention is drawn to the need for immediate action by any V.S.L. who wishes to attend the advanced course at Bentley this autumn. In addition details of the G.S.L./Commissioner advance course at Bentley were sent to all A.D.C.s (L.T.) recently but Leaders who are interested and who have not received any information about the course should contact me immediately so that a place can be reserved for them.

In addition, any Cub Scout Leader interested in a non-residential advanced course during the winter

months should contact Mrs. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking, as quickly as possible so that we can decide whether or not to proceed with such a course.

On the information received from the A.D.C.s (L.T.) during recent months, we shall be planning the location and number of basic training courses for all Scouters during the autumn to the spring 1981. If you have not made known to your A.D.C. your interest in attending any course, please do so immediately.

DAVID BARRELL

Courses

Scout Fellowship

Leatherhead November

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 27th/28th September

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 11th/12th October
(Residential)

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Any interest in a non residential course during the winter should be notified to

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse & 20th/21st September &
elsewhere 13th & 25th/26th October

G.S.L./COMMISSIONERS

Bentley Copse 4th/5th October plus
22nd/23rd November

Water Activities Supervisory Skills Course

11th/12th October

Surrey Scout Leaders Activity Weekend

Bentley Copse 13th/14th September

Pack Holiday Course

Bentley Copse 18th/19th October

E.J. Mackie, 30 Morton Road, East Grinstead.

J. Gibbons, 115 Hermitage Woods Crescent, St. Johns Woking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

B.C. Wood, 18 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Information from J. Forbat, 46 Firlands, Ellesmere Road, Weybridge.

J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne, Sussex.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

Cub Scouts

At the last County Cub Scout Leaders meeting held on Monday, 2nd June, the question of the payment of camp registration fees for Packs camping within the County of Surrey, was raised. Some people felt that it was no longer necessary to pay and others said that the fee had to be paid; to be honest I wasn't sure. I have now consulted the notes of the D.C.s' Symposium held in October 1977 when the matter was discussed and the position is as follows: The Camp Leader should complete the H.Q. Permission to Camp Form plus the Surrey supplementary form and hand it to the A.D.C. (Cub Scouts) or D.C. together with a wet and dry programme and a cheque (or postal order) for £1.50 at least 2 months before the camp. These forms together with the cheque or

P.O. will be sent to the D.C. in whose District the camp is being held who may waive the registration fee if he so desires. If the fee is waived, the cheque or P.O. will be returned to the Camp Leader.

It should be noted that this is only for camps or holidays within Surrey. If the camp or holiday is being held at any National Scout Campsite, no registration fee is required at all. If the camp or holiday is being held anywhere else then the fee is most definitely required, when the cheque or P.O. should be made payable to the Scout County in which the camp or holiday is being held.

I hope that this clarifies the position for all concerned.

STEVE HALL

Venture Scouts

National Scout Service and Parade, Windsor

37 Queen's Scouts represented the County at the Parade this year. Together with the Queens' Scouts from Greater London South West they were contingent 'A' and lead the Parade. Each year there is a ticket for a Scouter to accompany the Queen's Scouts and this year I gave the ticket to Brian Parker, who as you probably know is a Cub Scout Leader in Guildford and Secretary of the Scout Sub-Committee. I quote the letter Brian wrote me after the Parade because I feel we should all share the pride that he felt on the day.

"Despite the near-arctic conditions — a sharp contrast to the previous week — the Parade and Service were both most memorable. As someone who didn't even become a "First Class" Boy Scout it was a privilege to be associated with the group of young people that did Scouting in Surrey proud".

Expeditions

I trust by now that all your plans are complete for your summer expeditions. The more I see of any activity the more I am convinced that the better the planning the better the event. It always surprises me

how many people think events just happen and no hard work in preparation is necessary. I am also convinced that the annual expedition is the real way to consolidate a Unit. I feel sure that all Units in Surrey will have really worthwhile expeditions this summer and I wish you all every success.

County Competitions

I feel sure that you are all now busy planning your programmes for the Autumn. The events run by the County are organised to help you write your programme. The dates of these events are published in the Diary elsewhere in "Surrey Scout".

Venture Scout Leaders Advanced Course

The application forms for this course are available from me now. I do hope that all Leaders who require training will make the effort this year and we can have a really large and worthwhile course.

Change of Address

For the third time and to keep my long suffering postman and the couple at 36 happy. PLEASE note my new address is ASH CROFT, 18 SOLE FARM ROAD, GREAT BOOKHAM, SURREY.

BRUCE WOOD

Water Activities

County Regatta Thorpe Park May 11th

A beautiful day with excellent conditions was enjoyed by all who attended, and this gave an ideal opportunity for Sea Scouts to be seen by the public, boating with enthusiasm. It was nice to see Groups attending for the first time and those Groups who have been to all the Regattas, which go to making

the competition that much better.

At the end of the day 1st Walton have mislaid 2 Haristrok buoyancy aids marked with a large 'V' under the label. If any Group has discovered they have one or both of these I would appreciate a call on Walton 40800.

RICHARD HOLLEY

Congratulations

QUEEN'S SCOUTS

A. Alexander	8th Ashford
M. Blumanthal	8th Ashford
K. Brewer	6th Staines
Miss J. Burchett	De Lucy (1st Lagham)
A. Craig	1st Whyteleafe
Miss D. Cook	De Lucy (1st Lagham)
M. Fensome	Juno, Woking
P. Herring	7th Farnham
N. McVitty	De Lucy (1st Lagham)
J. Penfold	Horley
M. Redit	Horley
M. Taylor	7th Farnham
Miss G. Weathers	7th Farnham
Miss T. Welland	7th Farnham
S. Woodison	6th Staines

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARDS

Richard Bensley	3rd Ashtead
Simon Browne	1st Frimley
Garry Cann	3rd Sheerwater
Roger Cannon	1st Shalford
Andrew Coe	1st Brookwood
Alastair Duncan	1st Normandy
Nicholas Glazzard	1st Ripley
James Goldstone	1st Cranleigh
Alastair Goodale	3rd Sheerwater
Matthew Haynes	2nd Horley
Simon Jennings	1st Cranleigh
Andrew Koniotes	1st Cranleigh
David Lee	7th Horley
Adrian Luckman	2nd Horley
David Luckman	2nd Horley
Paul Mortar	1st Cranleigh
Keith Parker	3rd Banstead
Ian Peake	1st Shalford
Andrew Phillips	1st Tadworth
Timothy Ridge	1st Cranleigh
Peter Smithin	1st Frimley
Iain White	2nd Horley
James Wilkins	1st Cranleigh
Guy Woodford	1st Cranleigh
Clifford Davey	4th Ewell
Mark Duncan	4th Ewell
Martin Lee	4th Ewell
David Leveridge	1st Oxted
Adrian Nelson	4th Walton on Thames
Anrew Oldfield	1st Egham
Colin Rennison	1st Egham
David Sack	4th Ewell
Andrew Staig	1st Oxted
Richard Wadey	1st Brookwood

County Chaplain

On the first Sunday in June, I drove up the M.11 to a small Essex village called Great Chesterford. The reason was the 25th birthday of a Cub Scout Pack I started while I was an undergraduate in Cambridge in 1955. The highlight for me was a tea party where I met seven of the original dozen boys who had been part of that first Pack. Most of them I had not seen since I left Cambridge in 1957 — so there was an initial problem about recognising them — all married, with young families of their own; seven little boys in short trousers had become seven adults a good deal taller than their middle-aged ex-Cubmaster! Once the first hesitations were over, we relaxed into the inevitable 'do you remember . . .' conversation that is the special mark of such occasions. In my own mind were the notes I had kept of the first meetings . . . no which lay behind the two big surprises. Two of the boys had caused me a great deal of irritation — to put it mildly! One had been kicked out of a pack meeting twice for unmitigated cheek. He was now the G.S.L. — Medal of Merit and all. The other was a boy about whom the mothers of other boys came to complain frequently . . . he had pinched their cub caps, torn their jerseys, thumped them on the way home . . . and finally was reported by the other boys as saying at school that he 'wasn't going to see that bloody old Cubmaster again'. But it turned out he had moved later to another village, and also become heavily involved in its Scout Troop. Now he was a delightful, happily married thirty-five year old, far and away the friendliest and most relaxed of all those at the tea party.

I am sure many of you will have had similar experiences. The only reason I write this personal note is not to revel in nostalgia — that is a dangerous emotion at the best of times. More important was the feeling of deep thankfulness I experienced as I drove back down the M.11 that evening. Thankfulness above all for the strength of the ideals and methods of Scouting, and for the real sense of brotherhood which had endured over so many years. That, it seems to me, is a precious gift which God has given to the world through this Movement of ours. We are all too aware of the problems we have, of all that we ought to be doing for the boys who join, but never fully carry out. Perhaps we should more often recognise the tremendous amount of joy and happiness and goodness which do come from our work. A simple sense of gratitude to Almighty God is nearer the heart of all true religion than we sometimes acknowledge. All our Scouting, if we will only stop and think, is full of reasons for saying 'thanks be to God' will all our heart.

KEITH HUXLEY

Bentley Copse

During recent weeks, there has been a disturbing increase in vandalism at the site. For some obscure reason, camping standards seem to be deteriorating on the site and boys are being allowed to damage trees, undergrowth, throw rubbish into the swimming pool, leave taps on and leave the site in a worse condition than it was when they arrived. The charge for camping at Bentley is lower than it is on Headquarters camp sites. We want to encourage the use of the site for the benefit of the boys, however, if the site is to be kept in decent condition it means that every camper must act responsibly and every Leader must check with the Warden whether there are jobs which could usefully be done during the period on site which will contribute to the development of Bentley. Leaders should be in the habit of asking their former 'host' whether they can do them a good turn before departure and the same should apply to the use of Bentley.

In future, if we find that damage is caused to the site, or sites occupied by troops are left in bad condition, then the persons responsible will not be allowed to camp again at Bentley. All arrivals must report to the Warden and must also report again before their departure from the site so that there can be no misunderstandings as to the condition of their site on departure.

DAVID BARRELL

County Directory

County

Secretary: Delete R. Sabin
Insert A. Tatham, 27 Newton Wood
Road, Ashted. Tel. 74484

Asst. Secretary: Delete A. Tatham.

Godalming

Treasurer: Delete D. Barker
Insert c/o District Secretary

Reigate

Treasurer: Delete D. Tapping
Insert S.W. Page, 42 Oakwood Close,
Redhill.

Staines

Secretary: Delete E. Newell
Insert R. Angel, 17 Commercial Road,
Staines. Tel. 58714

Sunbury & Shepperton

District Chaplain: Delete Rev. P. Ball
Insert Rev. J.V.E. Tucker,
The Vicarage, Thames Street,
Sunbury.

Walton & Weybridge

Treasurer: Delete G.B. Haydon
Insert B. Clarke, 28 York Gardens,
Walton-on-Thames. Tel. 26155

County Diary

July

- | | | |
|-------|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| 5-6 | Cubmeet 80 | Various |
| 7 | Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |
| 12-13 | District Administrator's Workshop | Guildford |
| 13 | Venture Scout First Aid Competition | |
| 14 | Programme & Training Sub-Committee | Dorking |
| 16 | Executive Committee | London |
| 18-20 | Venture Scout Camp | New Forest |
| 29 | Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee | Ewell |

September

- | | | |
|-------|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| 8 | Water Activities Sub-Committee | 'Ajax' |
| 13-14 | Scouting for Scout Leaders | Bentley Co |
| 14 | Sailing Regatta | |
| 18 | Venture Scout Sub-Committee | Dorking |
| 19-21 | National Scouters Conference | York |
| 27-28 | County Patrol & Camping Competition | Walton Firs |

October

- | | | |
|----|--|-------------|
| 6 | Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |
| 11 | Chief Scout Award Presentation | Banstead |
| 12 | Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club Annual Shoot | Bisley |
| 13 | Cub Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |
| 14 | Programme & Training Sub-Committee | Bookham |
| 15 | Executive Committee | London |
| 26 | Venture Scout Cooking Competition | |
| 27 | County Chaplain's Meeting | Dorking |
| 28 | Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee | Ewell |

November

- | | | |
|-------|-----------------------------------|--------|
| 1 | Swimming Gala | Guildf |
| 9 | District Commissioners' Symposium | |
| 15-16 | Venture Competition | |

December

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------|---------|
| 2 | Water Activities Sub-Committee | Staines |
| 4 | Venture Scout Sub-Committee | Dorking |

September "Surrey Scout"

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